



HackIllinois 2026

How to Hack

Welcome!

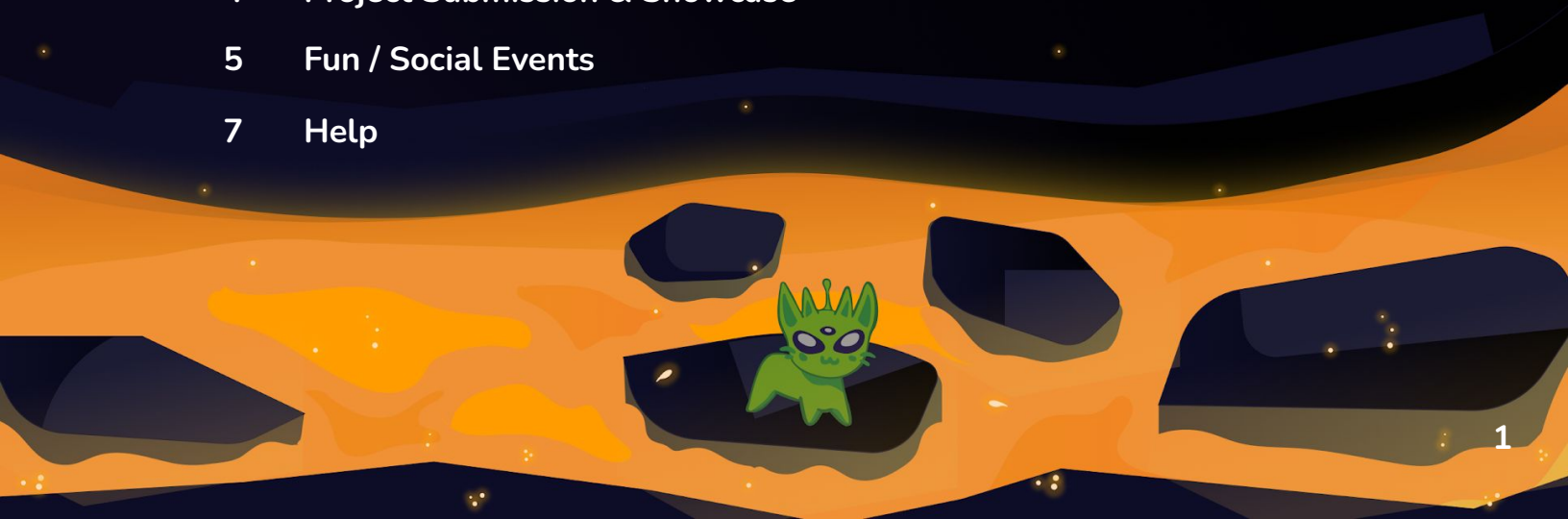
We have provided a manual to help our first time explorers on this exciting adventure! Below, you will find a guide on what events to attend to make the most of your time at HackAstra! For the best experience, we would recommend our Hackstronauts to review this alongside our [Attendee Guide](#). Let's get to hacking!

We hope this guide answers any questions you might have, but feel free to send a message on [Discord](#) or an email at contact@hackillinois.org if you have any additional questions! You can also visit hackillinois.org for more information such as our [FAQ section](#), [schedule](#), and mentor/judge bios.

Note that all times on this document are in CST (GMT - 6:00).

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Helpful / Skill-Building Events

02/27 (Friday) 3:00-5:00PM

Company Expo

Explore a career outside your occupation as a Hackstronaut and network with representatives from our sponsored companies in the **Siebel CS Atrium!**

02/27 (Friday) 5:00-6:00 PM

Opening Ceremony

Report to the mothership (**Siebel CS 1404**) for the mission briefing. Captains and Crew will set you on your maiden voyage, and you will receive tasks for the coming days of exploration.

BEGIN HACKING!!

02/27 (Friday) 7:30-8:30 PM

John Deere Track Intro

Stargazers on the John Deere track...

Report to
Sidney Lu MEB

Modal Track Intro

Cadets whose fate is written in the stars with this track...

Report to
Siebel CS 1302

Stripe Track Intro

Cosmic voyagers involved with the Stripe track...

Report to
Siebel CS 0216

CAT Track Intro

Hackstronauts working on the CAT Track...

Report to
Siebel CS 2405



Helpful / Skill-Building Events

02/27 (Friday) 8:30-9:30 PM

Team Matching

Solo Hackstronauts do not fret!

Report to [Siebel CS 0218](#) to find your dream team!

02/27 (Friday) 9:00-10:00 PM

Project Development Workshop (Fulcrum)

For those needing time and space to plan ...

Report to [Siebel CS 2405](#) and speak with mentors for guidance

02/27 (Friday) 10:00 - 11:00 PM

Deployment Workshop (Women in CS)

In partnership with WCS, head over to [Siebel CS 0216](#) to learn about the various deployment methods for your mission!

02/28 (Saturday) 11:59 PM

TEAM & TRACK PRE-CONFIRMATION FORM DUE

02/28 (Saturday) 1:30-2:30 PM

MLH GitHub Workshop

Get hands-on support learning GitHub and customizing your profile with MLH.

Launch your GitHub journey in [Siebel CS 0220](#).



Project Submission & Showcase

03/01 (Sunday) 6:00 AM

Submissions Due

Submit all of your hard work to DevPost.
Congratulations Hackstronauts! Your mission is complete!

03/01 (Sunday) 9:00 -11:30 AM

Demos Begin at Siebel CS (ARRIVE BY 8:45)

For both Pro and General Track:
Showcase your work in a Science Fair Style Presentation

03/01 (Sunday) 12:00 - 1:30 PM

HackVoyagers Pitch

Top 7 HackVoyager teams will participate in a Shark Tank inspired showcase, streamed live so Hackstronauts can tune in from their stations.

03/01 (Sunday) 2:00 - 3:00 PM

Closing Ceremony

Report to the mothership in Siebel CS 1404
Captains and crew will debrief mission results.
Winners will be announced.
Attend for information on our raffle prizes!



Fun / Social Events

02/27 (Friday) 2:30-4:30 PM

Solar Search

Warm up your mind before the competition, and participate in our intergalactic scavenger hunt to help unravel some mysteries onboard at **Siebel CS Atrium**.

Gain points to use in the point shop and redeem swag!

02/27 (Friday) 6:00-7:30 PM

RSO Expo

Report to the **Siebel CS Atrium** for our RSO Expo (UIUC Clubs)

02/27 (Friday) 11:00 PM - 1:00 AM

IMC Poker Tournament

For those who signed up for a fun time... Report to **Siebel CS 2405**

02/28 (Saturday) 1:00-2:00 PM

Cosmic CTF Challenge

For those seeking more points and a test of their capabilities...

Report to **Siebel CS 2405** for a mind exercise!

02/28 (Saturday) 5:00-7:00 PM

The Astral Exhibition

Come to the **Siebel CS Atrium** for some carnival activities prepared by the crew!

Let your mind unwind with some exciting games!



Fun / Social Events Cont.

02/28 (Saturday) 5:30-6:30 PM

Capital One Smash Tournament

Prove your worth in Super Smash Bros, open to all who signed up!
Come to Siebel CS 2405 for Capital One's exciting opportunity!

02/28 (Saturday) 9:00-10:00 PM

Code in the Dark w/Caterpillar

Report to Siebel CS 2405 for some vibe coding detox
with a change in environment to get those minds running.

02/28 (Saturday) 10:30 - 11:30 PM

Clash Royale Tournament

To those who signed up for a breathtaking tournament...
Report to Siebel CS 1404 for another opportunity to show off
to your fellow Hackstronauts!





Help

If you have any questions, comments, or concerns during the event please feel free to reach out to us at contact@hackillinois.org, type @Help Desk in any of our Help Channels or create a ticket via [Discord](#), or come to our in-person help desks at Siebel, located right outside of the **ACM Office (1104)**!

Terms & Conditions

By registering for this event, you are agreeing to the HackIllinois & MLH [terms and conditions](#).

Thank You!

Thank you for taking the time to read through this guide. For more details and the official event schedule, please refer to the HackIllinois website [here](#). We hope you have an enjoyable time at HackIllinois 2026 and launch something stellar!

